

knows a decent bit about me, but it's unlikely that they know as much as the others.

The same applies to other social media networks such as Twitter, or Instagram, Snapchat, etc. All of them are indulging in data collection and big data analysis, without a doubt, but they are just smaller and thus a little less relevant than the three big guys we've covered first. However, in no way should you underestimate the power of the unknown companies that you have never heard of, who make up this set called *others*.

Cambridge Analytica is one of the companies who are part of the other list, as are several other big data firms who specialise in gathering data about people, which they then sell to ad networks or even directly to the three mentioned before. More often than not, however, they're used to specifically target people at an almost individual level, which makes even Facebook's targeting seem primitive.

Companies such as Acxiom, Alliance Data, Corelogic, Nielson, Equifax, Experian, and many, many more, are gathering and analysing data on billions of people across the globe.

What data is gathered and how? Banking is typical, and when you get a credit card every purchase you make goes into a big data pile where you're a bunch of data points. Even if you're not specifically an individual, you are most certainly part of a subset or group that is being analysed.

Even when you make offline purchases of products that have, say, a warranty, and even if you pay in cash, you're still marked as a customer using a name and at least a phone number and typically an email address as well. You have a car? When you get it serviced at a large center, you are logged as a car owner, and someone somewhere will find that data useful. Someone selling car insurance, for example, or cheap car parts... this is why all data is considered important, no matter how insignificant it seems.

6. Digit

It would be seriously unfair of me to write a piece like this and then not share what data we collect about you.

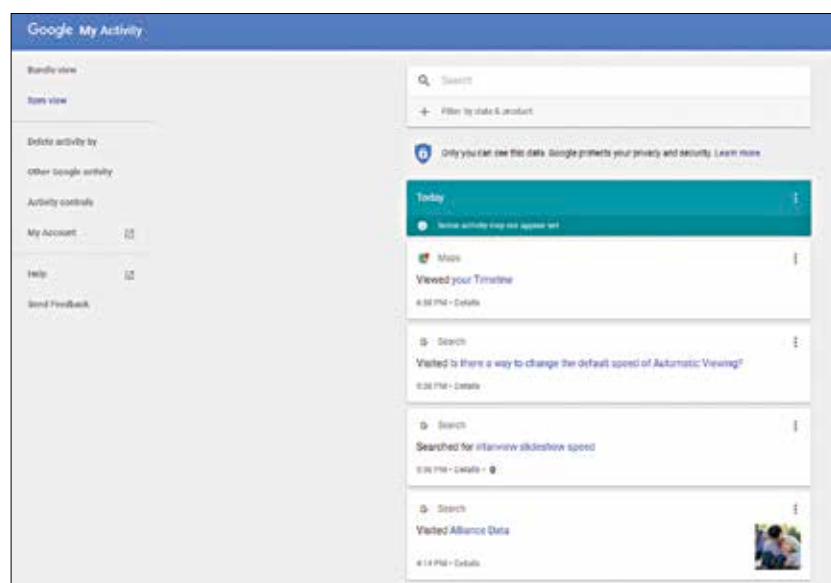
For instance, we have a database of lakhs of people who have subscribed to Digit magazine in the past. What do we use it for? To send you irritating emails trying to get you to buy the latest issue (if you're not subscribed already). Of course we don't spend any money on sanitation and data gathering, so there are many errors, as many of you subscribers have probably noticed, because you still get emails to buy a magazine that's being delivered to you anyway.

video production team are by far the inhouse stars because of this.

NOW WHAT?

Well, that's really up to your perspective. To be honest, we're only looking to keep you informed about how every action you take all add up to making a profile about you somewhere.

However, an aspect we have to be wary of is of course the weaponisation of data in order to influence us in ways we might not be so comfortable with.



Everything you have searched for is here. Every. Single. Thing!

In terms of online, we know anything that Google Analytics tells us about our visitors, and not much more. Of course we do have affiliate links on pages that mention products. If you're going to buy something anyway, please support us by buying it using our affiliate link to help fund the site.

None of our data is sold to anyone, and honestly, it's not even used in-house. It's something that actually irks me. Big data users we certainly aren't.

On social media, we employ pretty standard boosting of articles in order to increase our reach, but I'm thrilled to be able to say that as per my information we have the highest organic reach of all of our competitors, and by far the highest engagement levels of all, because we rely solely on the quality of our content instead of clickbait, and other silly methods that only result in a loss of respect. Our social media managers, editorial folk and

Using our own confirmation bias to make our views more stringent is one aspect we might not like. Data about us being used to subtly get us to vote differently is another thing we might not like. In general, none of us wants our data taken from us without our knowledge, and this is where staying informed and holding companies accountable for their actions comes in. Even the whole Cambridge Analytica fiasco wasn't necessarily a data breach, because that data was given willingly for just a few dollars in exchange for a pretend survey.

Honestly, none of us are going to ever go back to the good old days of internet anonymity, so it's best to give up that pipe dream and accept reality. You exist as data online, and nothing is going to change that... unless you fool the system or delete yourself... which is exactly what the next story in this series is about... 